JOSEPH GACHURU

SOFTWARE ENGINEER INTERN | BACKEND DEVELOPMENT | API INTEGRATION

Nairobi, Kenya | GitHub: github.com/Jigishas | LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/joseph-gachuru | Portfolio: portfolio-site-phi-self.vercel.app

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software Engineering candidate with hands-on experience developing and supporting web applications, integrating REST APIs, working with SQL databases, and troubleshooting application issues. Practical experience with PHP/Laravel, Python/Flask, JavaScript/TypeScript, React, and Git through a production marketplace platform and personal projects. Brings a problem-solving mindset, attention to detail, clear communication, and an interest in building secure, reliable software for real-world business needs. Eager to contribute to backend services, quality assurance, technical documentation, and cross-functional delivery.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: PHP, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, Java (foundational), Object-Oriented Programming

Backend & APIs: Laravel, Flask, Node.js, Express.js, REST APIs, API integration, authentication concepts, request/response troubleshooting

Frontend: React, Vite, HTML5, CSS3, Tailwind CSS, Progressive Web Apps (PWA)

Databases: MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, relational database concepts, data validation, query troubleshooting

Testing & Engineering: Debugging, functional testing, problem solving, Git/GitHub, documentation, Agile collaboration, environment configuration

Tools & Deployment: Postman, Linux, Docker, Nginx, Cloudflare, Render, Vercel

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

PLAT-DEL | Software Engineering Intern / Industrial Attachment | Nairobi, Kenya | May 2026 – Aug 2026

- Developed and maintained marketplace and delivery-platform features across frontend and backend components using React, JavaScript, PHP/Laravel, REST APIs, SQL, and Git.
- Integrated frontend workflows with backend APIs and investigated issues involving authentication, cookies, CORS, HTTP responses, and cross-origin requests.
- Supported debugging and production troubleshooting across application routing, server configuration, static assets, permissions, and deployment environments.
- Reviewed API request patterns, polling, caching opportunities, and asset delivery to identify potential frontend performance improvements.
- Worked with database-backed user, vendor, partner, and delivery workflows while applying version control, configuration management, testing, and technical documentation.

Londiani Sub-County Hospital | Software / ICT Support Experience | Kericho County, Kenya | 3 Months

- Provided day-to-day technical support to staff, helping troubleshoot common computer, software, and connectivity issues.
- Supported digital operations and information-handling activities, with attention to accuracy, confidentiality, and reliable record management.
- Communicated technical issues and solutions to users and strengthened practical problem-solving, documentation, and service-support skills.

SELECTED PROJECTS

HealthyCoffee – Coffee Leaf Disease & Deficiency Detection | React, Vite, PWA, Python, Flask, PyTorch, Docker

- Built an AI-enabled web application that accepts coffee-leaf images and returns model-based disease or nutrient-deficiency classifications.
- Implemented a React interface with camera capture and image upload, and integrated it with a Flask inference API for backend processing.
- Worked on API integration, error handling, deployment configuration, and offline-capable PWA functionality.

Personal Portfolio Platform | React, TypeScript, Vite, Tailwind CSS, Express.js

- Built and deployed a responsive portfolio to present software engineering projects and technical experience.
- Implemented reusable interface components, responsive layouts, contact functionality, and a Node.js/Express backend.

Data Engineering & Analytics Projects | Python, SQL, Pandas, NumPy, Apache Airflow, Spark, Power BI

- Practiced data ingestion, transformation, analysis, and visualization using Python and SQL alongside data-processing and orchestration tools.

EDUCATION

Kirinyaga University: Bachelor of Science in Software Engineering | 2023 – Present

Relevant Coursework: Object-Oriented Programming, Data Structures and Algorithms, Database Systems, Web Development, Software Testing, Systems Engineering